# After a fall: protect confidence as well as safety

> *Fear is understandable. The aim is safer movement, not automatically stopping all activity.*

## Look for a cause

A fall may relate to balance, vision, medicines, dizziness or a home hazard. Ask what happened without blaming the person. Report a fall even when it seems minor; the history can help prevent another.

## Make everyday routes easier

Remove loose items and cables, improve lighting towards the bathroom and review footwear, handholds and walking aids. Adapt changes to the person’s routine. Ask for an appropriate strength and balance programme rather than imposing inactivity.

## Review medicines, do not stop them alone

Bring the full medicine list if dizziness, sleepiness or unsteadiness has developed. A clinician can consider medicines alongside vision, mobility and health conditions.

## Head injuries need attention

After a head injury, increasing drowsiness, vomiting, new weakness, altered speech or loss of consciousness needs urgent help. People taking blood thinners need prompt medical advice even if they initially feel well. A normal-looking scalp does not exclude internal injury.

### Sudden confusion is not just ageing

A sudden change in awareness or attention needs immediate assessment. Stay with the person, note when it began and bring medicines. Do not pull someone to standing when severe pain, inability to bear weight or a possible serious injury is present.

> For a life-threatening emergency in India, call 112. Elsewhere use your local emergency number.

## Questions you may have

### Will reporting a fall mean I must stop walking?

The assessment should help preserve safe independence. Explain your goals and concerns.

## What to remember

Investigate the change and make movement safer without blame.

## Sources and further reading


National Institute on Aging — falls and fractures
https://www.nia.nih.gov/health/falls-and-falls-prevention/falls-and-fractures-older-adults-causes-and-prevention

CDC — facts about falls
https://www.cdc.gov/falls/data-research/facts-stats/index.html

FDA — use medicines wisely
https://www.fda.gov/consumers/womens-health/use-medicines-wisely

NHS — head injury and concussion
https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/head-injury-and-concussion/

NHS — sudden confusion
https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/confusion/

Government of India — Emergency Response Support System 112
https://112.gov.in/about


Educational information supports understanding and does not replace individual medical care. Follow your clinician’s plan. Do not change medicines on your own. Sources checked: 24 October 2026.

Website: https://home-visiting-icu-doctor.vercel.app/#wikiSection
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